

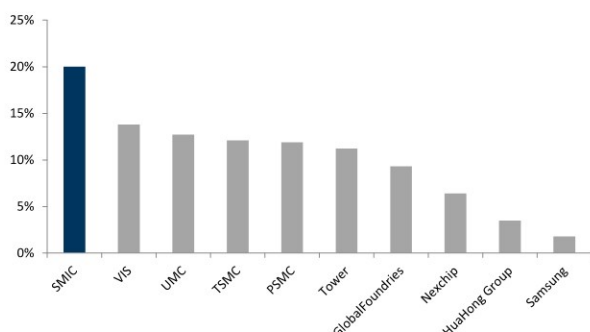
SMIC (0981.HK): AI to drive 2H26 growth; strongest revenues QoQ in 2Q26 among global top 10 foundries; Buy

We are positive on SMIC and expect 3Q26 / 4Q26 revenues to stay at the high level of 2Q26, driving 2H26 revenues at +12% HoH, or +27% YoY, riding on the growing generative AI trend in China, supporting both its matured nodes (e.g. analog / power ICs) and advanced nodes (e.g. local AI chips), rising localization trend, and the company's continuous capacity expansion. As we highlighted in [CHIPS IV](#), we expect China Semis Capex to grow at +13% / +15% / +15% in 2026-28E, driven by memory and advanced nodes capacity expansion. SMIC remained a global top three foundry in 2Q26 by revenues, per TrendForce ([link](#)), with revenues growth QoQ at 20%, outperforming the top 10 foundries' aggregate revenues growth of 11.5% QoQ, and saw the strongest revenues QoQ growth among the global top 10, reflecting China's strong AI demand and customers diversifying their suppliers to better secure capacity. Maintain Buy.

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Exhibit 1: QoQ Revenue Growth Rates of Top 10 Global Foundries (2Q26)



Source: Company data, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Generative AI to drive growth ahead: As we highlighted in [CHIPS IV](#), we estimate China AI chips TAM to grow at +142% / +69% / +6% CAGRs in 2025-30E to US\$4,123bn / US\$678bn / US\$66bn by 2030E in our Bull / Base / Bear cases, and to support our base case, SMIC would need to allocate 54% to 71% of its capex to 7nm and advanced. As we highlighted in [Global Server TAM](#), we expect leading Chinese cloud platforms to grow capex by 80% / 20% / 18% YoY in 2026-28E, and we raised our estimates by 37% / 44% / 55% in 2026-28E. Other than the strong AI Chips demand in China driving SMIC's advanced nodes, we see mature nodes also supported by related AI demand, such as analog IC or power semis. The global-tier

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peers' capacity being occupied by AI / leading processing nodes, also offers opportunities to Chinese foundries for non-AI demand or mature nodes.

Positive 2H26 outlook: We expect 3Q26 / 4Q26 revenues to stay at the high level of 2Q26, driving 2H26 revenues at +12% HoH, or +27% YoY, with UT rate to remain above 95% in 2H26. New pricing for wafers taped out in 4Q25 and 1Q26 is expected to take effect in 3Q26, supporting GM despite rising depreciation. With capacity remaining tight for AI-related computing, logic, BCD and optical-module-related chips, we expect it is less likely to see an ASP downward trend in 2H26. We remain positive on SMIC's 2H26 outlook, supported by high utilization, improving pricing and continued demand from AI-related applications.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – SMIC

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on SMIC A/H. Our 12-m target price for the H-share is **HK\$153.0** and is based on an 80.7x 2028E P/E, discounted back to 2026E with a COE of 15%. Our target multiple is based on SMIC's EPS growth relative to peers' P/E vs. EPS growth correlation. Our 12-m target price for the A-share is **Rmb257.9** and is based on a 196% premium over the H-share that is in line with the avg of SMIC's A/H premium since Jan 2024.

Key risks: 1) Weaker-than-expected demand in smartphones and consumer electronics; 2) Slower-than-expected product diversification and capacity expansions; and 3) Access to certain equipment/material supply may be restricted as the company is on the US BIS Entity List.

0981.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$153.00	Price: HK\$65.15	Upside: 134.8%
688981.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb257.90	Price: Rmb122.00	Upside: 111.4%

Buy		GS Forecast			
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: HK\$521.3bn / \$66.4bn	Revenue (\$ mn)	9,326.8	11,694.2	14,392.1	18,422.0
Enterprise value: HK\$700.2bn / \$89.2bn	EBITDA (\$ mn)	4,919.9	6,668.3	8,009.4	9,476.5
3m ADTV: HK\$7.6bn / \$973.7mn	EPS (\$)	0.09	0.18	0.23	0.32
China	P/E (X)	81.5	47.2	36.6	25.8
Greater China Technology	P/B (X)	2.6	2.9	2.7	2.4
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	1.4	1.1	1.5	1.8
	CROCI (%)	7.5	8.7	8.9	9.0
	FCF yield (%)	(7.1)	(4.4)	(7.8)	(7.1)
		6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
	EPS (\$)	0.09	0.05	0.05	0.05

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 18 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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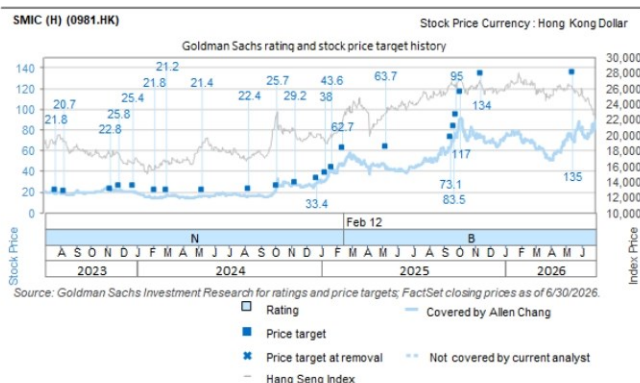
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

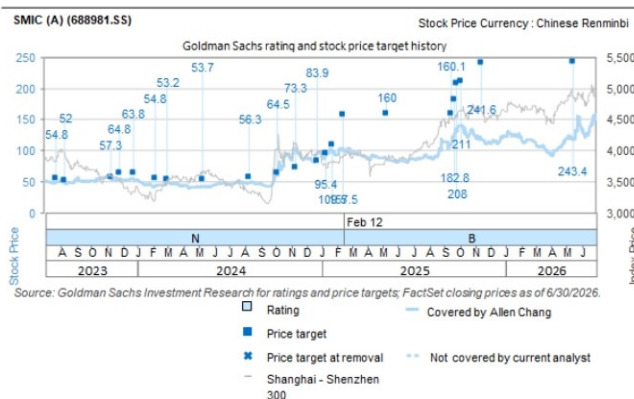
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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Target price history table(s)

SMIC (A) (688981.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
15-Aug-26	257.90	132.87
15-May-26	243.40	119.02
14-Nov-25	241.60	118.18
05-Oct-25	211.00	140.13
26-Sep-25	208.00	132.27
22-Sep-25	182.80	128.92
15-Sep-25	160.10	108.66
10-May-25	160.00	85.83
12-Feb-25	157.50	104.32
22-Jan-25	109.50	100.24
09-Jan-25	95.40	91.32
23-Dec-24	83.90	95.18
10-Nov-24	73.30	100.30
06-Oct-24	64.50	59.99
12-Aug-24	56.30	48.78
10-May-24	53.70	42.99
02-Mar-24	53.20	48.51
06-Feb-24	54.80	44.97
26-Dec-23	63.80	51.85
28-Nov-23	64.80	54.55
10-Nov-23	57.30	54.39

SMIC (H) (0981.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
15-Aug-26	153.00	70.80
15-May-26	135.00	71.15
14-Nov-25	134.00	73.50
05-Oct-25	117.00	90.90
26-Sep-25	95.00	72.95
22-Sep-25	83.50	73.35
15-Sep-25	73.10	63.00
10-May-25	63.70	43.00
12-Feb-25	62.70	47.95
22-Jan-25	43.60	42.10
09-Jan-25	38.00	31.45
23-Dec-24	33.40	29.10
10-Nov-24	29.20	28.55
06-Oct-24	25.70	27.35
12-Aug-24	22.40	16.54
10-May-24	21.40	16.26
02-Mar-24	21.20	17.04
06-Feb-24	21.80	15.34
26-Dec-23	25.40	20.15
28-Nov-23	25.80	22.75
10-Nov-23	22.80	21.80

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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